

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 2
 ♥ K J 8 5 3 2
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ 8 2

♠ A Q

♥ 10 7 4

♦ K J 6 3

♣ K Q J 7



♠ 10 9 5 4 3

♥ A Q 9

♦ 2

♣ 9 5 4 3

♠ K J 7

♥ 6

♦ A Q 10 8 7 5

♣ A 10 6

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♦
All Pass			
6♦ by South			

Partner's 3♦ bid shows a very good hand with probable slam interest. It is very tempting to say 3NT now but you don't have ♥s stopped and don't know if partner does. So with good ♦ support you bid 4♦. Partner bids 4NT. What is your response?

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠A and ♦K. But you don't have the ♦Q so you answer 5♥. Partner bids 6♦.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 10 3

♦ A Q 10 7

♣ 10 6 5

♠ A 6 5 2

♥ Q J 5 2

♦ K J 3

♣ 8 2



♠ J 3

♥ 7

♦ 9 8 6 5 4 2

♣ J 9 4 3

♠ K 10 8

♥ A K 9 8 6 4

♦ -

♣ A K Q 7

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South
good idea so you say 6♥.

Your partner's 3♥ is a limit-raise, 11-12 points with ♥ support.

What you want to know is whether partner holds the ♠A. If you bid 4NT and he shows two Key-Cards all will be well, you will know they are the two missing Aces. But if he shows just 1 Key-Card you will be in the soup since you can't tell if that Key-Card is the useful ♠A or the practically useless ♦A. So you don't use RKCB, you use control-showing and bid 4♣. Partner says 4♥.

Partner would have control-bid ♦s if he had the Ace. You may not think that helps but it does since now you can bid RKCB. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♣. What is your next bid?

It was a lot of work but you have figured out that partner holds 11-12 points including one Key-Card which must be the ♠A. It looks like the slam is a

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 3
 ♥ Q 9 2
 ♦ K Q 8 7 5
 ♣ 10 7 2

♠ K 8 6 5 2

♥ K J 10 7

♦ -

♣ A 9 8 3



♠ J

♥ A 6 5 4 3

♦ J 10 9 4

♣ 6 5 4

♠ A Q 9 7 4

♥ 8

♦ A 6 3 2

♣ K Q J

Your 4♦ bid is a Splinter Bid, showing opening hand strength, at least 4 ♠s, and a singleton or void in ♦s. Partner bids 4NT.

You have 2 Key-Cards, the ♠K and the ♣A. So do you bid 5♥?

No. You have two Key-Cards **AND** a void. So you bid 5NT. Partner bids 6♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4♦	Pass	4NT
Pass	5NT	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by South			

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 3 2
 ♥ J 3 2
 ♦ 8 7 6 4 3
 ♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 10 8

♥ K 9 8 4

♦ K 9

♣ K 10 6 5



♠ 9 7 6 5 4

♥ Q 5

♦ 10 5 2

♣ A 7 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 10 7 6

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9

West	North	East	South
			2NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	3♥
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
All Pass			
5♥ by South			

Your partner's 2NT opener is 20-21 points and the 3♣ bid is Stayman.

You know of 33 points and you know of an 8-card ♥ fit. The math tells you that 6♥ should be a good slam but you might as well check Key-Cards, that's why the convention was invented. So you bid 4NT and partner answers 5♥.

You say "Darn!" You are missing just one Key-Card, but you are also missing the trump Queen. And with partner holding only a 4-card suit that Queen might well win a trick. Knowing that at best the slam will depend on a trump finesse you pass 5♥.